

VA INTERMEDIATE – 07-09-2026

Directions for questions 1 to 3: The sentences given in each question, when properly sequenced, form a coherent paragraph. Each sentence indicated is with a number. Choose the most logical order of sentences to construct a coherent paragraph and indicate the correct sequence of numbers in the box provided below each question.

1. The British created the tribal areas as a buffer between undivided India and Afghanistan granting administrative autonomy and giving special privileges to Maliks, or tribal elders, in return for services such as maintenance of peace and keeping the Khyber Pass open.
2. Comprising a total population of 5.7 million, the Federally Administered Tribal Area (FATA) has seven distinct areas inhabited by Pashton tribes.
3. The tribal areas are located on the Pakistan side of the 2,400 km long Durand line that separates this country from Afghanistan.
4. This system continued under independent Pakistan: the government refrained from establishing direct rule, universal adult franchise was extended here as late as 1997 and political parties remain outlawed.

Solution:

It is clear that 3 and 2 go together (describing the area and its population) and 1 and 4 go together. 'This system' in 4 refers to the one created by the British, mentioned in 1. It follows 2 – 'Pashton tribe' in 2 becomes 'the tribal area' in 1.

Ans : (3214)

Directions for questions 1 to 3: The sentences given in each question, when properly sequenced, form a coherent paragraph. Each sentence indicated is with a number. Choose the most logical order of sentences to construct a coherent paragraph and indicate the correct sequence of numbers in the box provided below each question.

1. Other scandals have included the cost of the allergy medicine Epipen, the excessive cost of insulin, an expensive cure for Hepatitis C and the enormous price increases in the cost of two heart drugs.
2. More such tales can be expected from the ongoing anti-trust investigation by the Department of Justice into possible price fixing in generic drugs.
3. The past year has brought a steady influence of grim news about the price of drugs.
4. New data on federal spending on programmes for the poor and the elderly show that last year \$9.2bn was spent on a single medicine - Harvoni, which cures Hepatitis C.
5. Much outrage has been caused by a price-gouging scheme for an AIDS medicine.

Solution:

Statement 3 begins the paragraph by stating the main point of discussion – the price of drugs. Statement 5 continues the idea by mentioning about the price-gouging scheme which resulted in much outrage. Hence 5 follows 3. Statements 1 and 4, respectively, further elaborate on what is stated in 3 and 5. Statement 2 concludes the paragraph by stating that more tales can be expected in the near future about the price fixing in generic drugs. Hence 3, 5, 1, 4, 2 form a logically coherent paragraph.

Ans : (35142)

Directions for questions 1 to 3: The sentences given in each question, when properly sequenced, form a coherent paragraph. Each sentence indicated is with a number. Choose the most logical order of sentences to construct a coherent paragraph and indicate the correct sequence of numbers in the box provided below each question.

1. A new front in this battlefield is emerging, as the government cracks down on international schools catering to Chinese citizens.
2. In the 1870s the Qing imperial court ended centuries of educational isolation by sending young men to America, only for the Communist regime to shut out the world again a few decades later.
3. The Communist party officially endorses international exchanges in education while at the same time preaching the dangers of Western ideas on Chinese campuses.
4. China has long oscillated between the urge to equip its elite with foreign knowledge and skills, and an opposing instinct to turn inward and rebuff such influences.
5. Today record numbers of Chinese study abroad: over half a million people left in 2015 alone, many for America.

Solution:

Only 4 is ideal as the opening sentence as it states the main idea – China's oscillation between the urge to equip its people with foreign knowledge and an instinct to rebuff such influences - on which the paragraph is based. 2 follows 4 by explaining how years of educational isolation ended in 1870 when the Qing imperial court sent young men to America and how the Communist regime shut out the world a few decades later. 5, which explains the present trend, is a continuation of 2. Statement 3 is a continuation of 5 as it corroborates what is stated in 5. Statement 1 is conclusive in nature. Hence 4, 2, 5, 3, 1 is the appropriate sequence.

Ans : (42531)

Directions for questions 4 and 5: In each question, there are four sentences. Each sentence has pairs of words/phrases that are italicized and highlighted. From the italicized and highlighted word(s)/phrase(s), select the **most appropriate** word(s)/phrase(s) to form correct sentences. Then, from the options given, choose the best one.

1. All the students of the class are seen *swatting* (a) / *swotting* (b) hard for the approaching board exams.
2. The researcher had to *pore* (a) / *pour* (b) over several tomes and documents to collect information pertaining to his thesis.
3. We could not gather any *substantive* (a) / *substantial* (b) information from his speech.
4. The visiting dignitary was provided accommodation in a luxury *suite* (a) / *suit* (b) of the best hotel in the city.

☐ a) baaa (Correct Answer - ✓)

☒ b) baba (Your answer - ✗)

☐ c) aaaa

☐ d) aaba

Solution:

Swat is to hit something, especially an insect, using your hand or a flat object. Swot is to study very hard. Only b makes sense here. To pore over something is to look at or read something very carefully. Pour is to make a liquid or other substance flow from a container in a continuous stream. The former is appropriate here. Hence a. Substantive means of substance or significance. Substantial means large in amount, value or importance. Hence only a suits the given context. A suite is a set of luxury rooms in a hotel. Suit refers to a set of clothes made of the same cloth. Only a is apt here.
Choice (A)

Directions for questions 4 and 5: In each question, there are four sentences. Each sentence has pairs of words/phrases that are italicized and highlighted. From the italicized and highlighted word(s)/phrase(s), select the **most appropriate** word(s)/phrase(s) to form correct sentences. Then, from the options given, choose the best one.

1. The **troop** (a) / **troupe** (b) of dancers received standing ovation from the audience for their spell-binding performance.
2. I had to take a **torturous** (a) / **tortuous** (b) route to reach my destination, as the thoroughfare was choc- a -bloc due to the political rally.
3. The restaurant has a wide range of dishes, belonging to various cuisine, to cater to the discerning **palate** (a) / **palette** (b).
4. The city is home to immigrants (a) / emigrants (b) from various parts of the world.

☐ a) abaa

☒ b) aaaa (Your answer - ✕)

☐ c) bbab

☐ d) bbaa

Solution:

A troupe refers to a group of actors, singers, dancers or acrobats who perform together. A troop is a cavalry unit under the command of a captain. Troops are also large contingents of soldiers forming a fighting force. A troop of animals or people is a group of them. Only troupe is appropriate in the given sentence.

Tortuous means long, convoluted and full of bends. Torturous means tormenting or hurting somebody physically or mentally. Only tortuous is appropriate here. The palate is the upper part of the inside of your mouth. A palette is the round-edged board an artist uses to mix paints on. Clearly, a suits the given context. An emigrant is a person who leaves his country to live in another. An immigrant is a person who has come to live permanently in a country that is not his own. Only a is appropriate in the given sentence.
Choice (D)

Directions for question 6 to 8: There are two blanks in each of the following sentences. From the pairs of words given below each sentence, choose the pair that fills the blanks most appropriately.

With its northern fogs and southern _____ on marines, its icebergs, currents and tides, explorers and battles and its literature, weather and trade, the Atlantic Ocean is the most important of the world's five oceans in terms of human _____.

☐ a) abundance . . . understanding

☒ b) influence . . . perspective (Your answer - ✓)

☐ c) accord . . . temperament

☐ d) prominence . . . conditions

Directions for question 6 to 8: There are two blanks in each of the following sentences. From the pairs of words given below each sentence, choose the pair that fills the blanks most appropriately.

Running a government is like _____ in a cricket match, and the early years are a/an _____; the time to get things done, take bold decisions and set the tone for the rest of the innings.

☐ a) bowling . . . hype

☐ b) batting . . . powerplay (Correct Answer - ✓)

☐ c) fielding . . . gamble

☒ d) umpiring . . . ordeal (Your answer - ✗)

Directions for question 6 to 8: There are two blanks in each of the following sentences. From the pairs of words given below each sentence, choose the pair that fills the blanks most appropriately.

Although Indian economy is growing at 7.5 per cent and some companies are becoming more productive and _____, we seem to be witnessing a “jobless growth” that does not _____ well for the future.

☒ a) profitable . . . bode (Your answer - ✓)

☐ b) prolific . . . augur

☐ c) prosperous . . . forecast

☐ d) bountiful . . . portend

Directions for question 9: The following question presents 4 statements of which 3, when placed in appropriate order would form a contextually complete paragraph. Pick the statement that is not part of that context and indicate the number corresponding with it in the box provided below the question.

1. Purse strings apart, the power of the executive to determine most of what parliament enacts is a fact of modern political history – true not only in India but also in parliamentary systems of government elsewhere.
2. In reality, real legislative power does not lie with ministers.
3. Lord Hailsham of St Marylebone, England’s Lord Chancellor for many years, after he had retired from his high office, coined a new word for the English Parliament: ‘executature,’ i.e., a legislative body under the control of the executive.
4. This would not be an exaggerated description of India’s Parliament, especially when the government of the day used to consist of members of only one political party – during the first three decades of our Republic.

Solution:

That the legislative body is controlled by the executive is the issue discussed. Statement 1 introduces the topic; 3 explains it by citing an example and 4 relates it to India and concludes the paragraph. Statements 1, 3 and 4 make a logical paragraph. 2 contradicts the issue and is irrelevant.
Ans : (2)

Directions for question 10: The following question presents 5 statements of which 4, when placed in appropriate order would form a contextually complete paragraph. Pick the statement that is not part of that context and indicate the number corresponding with it in the box provided below the question.

1. Scientists, Cohen surmised, were not reporting their unsuccessful research.
2. They focused in particular on incentives within science that might lead even honest researchers to produce poor work unintentionally.
3. In 1962 Jacob Cohen, a psychologist at New York University, reported an alarming finding.
4. Cohen reckoned most of the studies he looked at would actually have detected the effects of their authors were looking for only 20% of the time-yet, in fact, nearly all reported significant results.
5. He had analyzed 70 articles published in the Journal of Abnormal Social Psychology and calculated their statistical "power" (a mathematical estimate of the probability that an experiment would detect a real effect).

Solution:

Only 3, which mentions the full name of the psychologist Jacob Cohen and talks about an alarming finding detected by Jacob Cohen, is clearly the opening statement. Statements 5 and 4 follow 3 by further elaborating on their statistical power. Statement 1 concludes the paragraph by stating what Cohen deduced from his analysis. Hence statements 3, 5, 4 and 1 form a paragraph. Statement 2, which brings in a different idea, does not form a part of the sequence mentioned above.

Ans : (2)

The world produces some 228 million tones of meat each year – the retail value of beef in the United States alone is \$74bn (£50bn). By 2050, according to the Food and Agriculture Organisation, the world will be eating twice as much meat as we eat now, primarily driven by the increased demand from a growing middle class in China and other developing nations. This kind of appetite accounts for why some 30 per cent of ice-free land in the world is used for growing food for animal livestock while just 4 per cent is used for crops destined for human consumption.

- ☐ a) The problem with meat is that it is not easily digestible.
- ☐ b) Some animals are very inefficient at converting vegetable protein into animal protein.
- ☐ c) This helps drive up the cost of meat.

☒ d) Besides, producing a kilo of meat requires between four and ten kilos of plant-based feed. (Your answer - ✓)

It is a fallacy that the elderly are a burden. Millions of old people do work that gives them dignity, autonomy, respect and a sense of continued social and economic relevance. Old people are living much longer today than they did a couple of generations back. Life expectancy at the time of independence was 35 years. Today it is 67 years. People are not just living to older ages; they are, for many more years, healthier in body and mind and, therefore, fit and willing to work.

- ☐ a) Yet we speak of the working age group as between 15 and 59 years, and assume that people below and above this age are "dependent".
- ☐ b) There is evidence that even impoverished people are today making many sacrifices to keep their children longer in school, but the same does not apply to poor older people.
- ☐ c) Many old people often continue to work until only days, weeks or months prior to death.
- ☒ d) However, despite evidence of useful work by many old people, it is routine for planners, scholars, even lay people to routinely speak of old people as a burden. (Your answer - ✓)

In the 1960s, economists predicted that paper would face a shortage in India when its per capita consumption of about 2 kg catches up with the global average of 35 kg. To be fair, in 1973 the country witnessed an unprecedented paper boom. More than 320 paper mills started operations since 1976 and after 1980 all these new mills started closing operations systematically. They shut mills citing adverse market conditions. Thus the pundits' forecast turned out to be mere bluff, like the Malthusian theory of population which predicted famine for an increasing population in geometric progression. Malthus did not figure technology in food production. In the case of paper, computers and telecommunications greatly displaced the use of paper.

1. Digital technologies and rapidly falling demand are pushing paper companies to the brink.
2. Paper production in India has not caught up with advance in digital technologies.
3. Economists' prediction about an increase in per capita consumption of paper turned out to be sheer bluff like the Malthusian prediction about an increase in population.
4. Since 1980, more paper mills in India have closed operations than anticipated by economists.

Directions for questions 13 and 14: Four alternative summaries are given below each text. Choose the option that best captures the essence of the text and indicate the number corresponding with it in the box provided below each question.

Incessant chirping of sparrows used to be common in our neighbourhood. Today, something is amiss; the tiny, round, brown bird, once ubiquitous, is fast disappearing. House sparrows, taxonomically classified as *Passer domesticus*, are intimately associated with human habitation. They nest in man-made structures such as eaves or walls of buildings and behind electric meters. But the last few decades have seen a massive decline in their population, as the birds cannot cope with the changing urban architecture, glass walls and steel surfaces, scarce water sources, and disappearing worms and bugs.

1. An account of the changing urban architecture, glass walls and steel surfaces, scarce water sources, and disappearing worms and bugs, the population of sparrows has dwindled.
2. House sparrows, classified as *Passer domesticus*, are fast disappearing from our neighbourhood due to modernisation.
3. The once ubiquitous, domesticated house sparrows are fast disappearing as they are unable to cope with the changing urban infrastructure.
4. As a result of urbanization, *Passer domesticus*, intimately associated with human habitation, is seen less and less nowadays.

Your Answer: 3 ✓

Directions for question 15: In the following question, the word at the top is used in four different ways, A to D. Choose the option in which the usage of the word is INCORRECT or INAPPROPRIATE.

DEAL

☒ a) When he entered the room, John was dealing the cards (Your answer - ✗)

☐ b) She made a deal with the company board member

☐ c) After graduation, he started a company which deals in automobile spare parts.

☐ d) When he was in Tokyo, he had to deal against some of the best in the industry (Correct Answer - ✓)